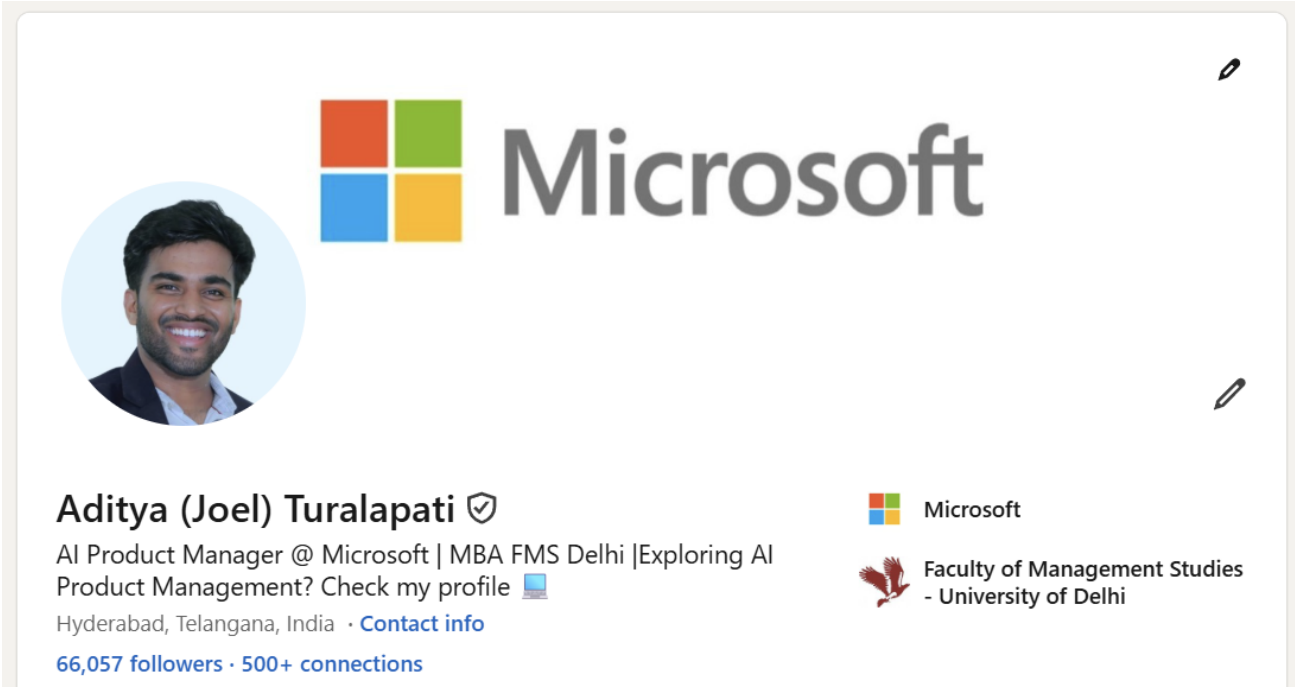
Product Management 101

Customer



Product Management 101

Key Questions This Course Helps You Answer

EXPLORE. QUESTION. THINK DEEPER.

1. What makes a product strategic — beyond being functional or successful?
2. How do great PMs balance user insight, business viability, and technical feasibility?
3. How do you define and refine product **strategy** across the lifecycle — from discovery to scale?
4. How do you decide what to build, when to build, and what to say “no” to?
5. How do PMs translate data, design, and technology into actionable strategy?
6. How can product strategy influence growth, brand positioning, and stakeholder alignment?
7. What does it take to drive strategic decisions in dynamic, cross-functional environments?

By the End of This Course, You Will Have

SKILLS. PERSPECTIVE. CONFIDENCE.

1. A structured understanding of how product strategy connects **vision → roadmap → growth**.



2. The ability to prioritise trade-offs and make **evidence-backed product decisions**.
3. Practical exposure to **frameworks**.
4. Stronger **product sense and storytelling** through teardowns and live case studies.
5. An understanding of how to work effectively with **engineering, design, marketing, and leadership teams**.
6. A **capstone product strategy case** demonstrating discovery, positioning, metrics, and stakeholder alignment.

Who is this Product for ?

- Customer

SESSION ROADMAP

One Story, Four Modules



01

Know Your Customer

Find the right people to learn from



02

Listen Like a Detective

Interviews & surveys that surface truth



03

See the Whole Person

Empathy maps, personas & the real job



04

Insight to Hypothesis

Turn learning into a testable bet

Whose Problem Are You Actually Solving?

> *“Do you always think of every kind of customer — or did you just think of yourself?”*

Customers rarely walk up and hand you their problems. Discovery is a reach-out sport — you go to them, again and again, long before you write a spec.

THE TAKEAWAY

Product thinking starts by widening the lens — from “what would I want” to “who else needs this, and how.”



Identifying the right
customer



Drawing insights from
the customer



Identifying the right
problem to solve

Finding the customers?

Recruiting Customers: Pick Your Constraint

There's no single right way to find people to talk to — the right method depends on what you have.



Money + Time

Hire a Research Agency

Outsource recruiting & moderation to specialists when budget and runway both allow it.



Time, Low Cost

Lean on Internal Teams

Your Customer Success or Pre-Sales teams already talk to customers daily use that access.



No Money, No Time

Run an Office Prototype Test

Pull 10–15 people internally for a quick, scrappy prototyping exercise.



Listen Like a Detective

The right questions turn a conversation into evidence — the wrong ones just confirm what you already believed.

STEP 2 OF 4

Customer Interviews: Four Ground Rules

Talk Problems, Not Solutions

Don’t pitch your idea. Get them describing their problem in their own words.

Ask About the Past, Not Opinions

Specific past behaviour beats hypothetical opinions every time.

Keep It Casual

A relaxed conversation gets you further than a formal Q&A.

Carry a Minimum Checklist

Know the few things you must cover — then let the conversation breathe.

One more distinction: KBC (Know-By-Chatting) vs. KYC (Know-Your-Customer) — casual small talk feels friendly, but only structured discovery gives you decisions to act on.

Stop Asking for Opinions. Start Asking for Specifics.

DON'T — CLOSED	DO — OPEN
Are you satisfied?	How satisfied or dissatisfied are you with this process?
Do you think you'd use this?	How would this fit into how you work today?
Have you done this before?	What difficulties have you run into doing this in the past?
Is this easy to use?	What's most confusing, and what worked well for you?
Do you like this?	What would you most want to change about it?

When You Can’t Sit Across the Table: Surveys

Self-Explanatory

No moderator to clarify every question must stand alone.

Anchored to One Goal

Each question should test: do people have this pain, and would they adopt a fix?

Short, to Avoid Fatigue

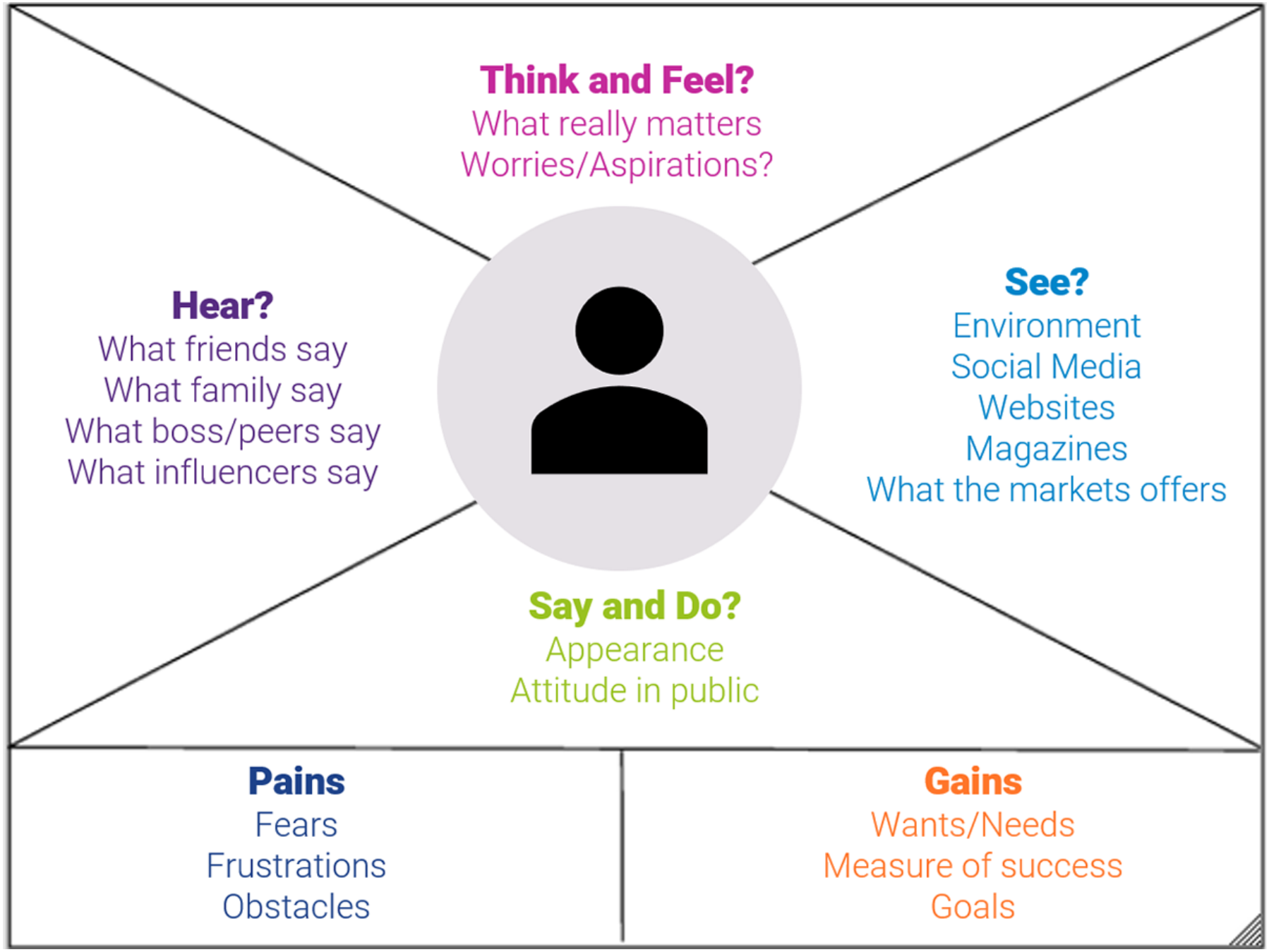
Long surveys get abandoned or answered carelessly.

Arc It: Broad → Specific → Open

Start wide, narrow to specifics, close with room for their own thoughts.

Avoid leading questions, and don’t forget to measure the current state — how customers think, feel, and behave today.

Empathy mapping?


Think and Feel?
What really matters
Worries/Aspirations?
Hear?
What friends say
What family say
What boss/peers say
What influencers say
See?
Environment
Social Media
Websites
Magazines
What the markets offers
Say and Do?
Appearance
Attitude in public
Pains
Fears
Frustrations
Obstacles
Gains
Wants/Needs
Measure of success
Goals

User Persona

"Take me to undiscovered holiday destinations away from the tourist traps."



NAME:
Savannah Rodriguez

PERSONAL BACKGROUND

AGE: 52

STATUS:
Divorced mother of two

EDUCATION:
Master's degree in Chemistry

PROFESSIONAL BACKGROUND

OCCUPATION:
Full-time
Pharmaceuticals company

INCOME:
65,000 per year

USER ENVIRONMENT

LOCATION:
Her office

DEVICES:
Mostly on a laptop, but also on her iPad.

PSYCHOGRAPHICS

Enjoys luxury spa retreats.

Hates tourist traps.

Appreciates exclusivity.

Enjoys authentic local cuisine.

Prefers to travel alone or with one other person.

Tends to favour quality over economy.

END GOALS

Use holiday-booking app to discover and book luxurious, off-the-beaten-track holiday destinations.

SCENARIO

"At least once a year, I like to go away on a luxury holiday. I try to discover places I've never been to before, and to stick to destinations that aren't yet overrun with tourists. I work full time, so I don't have that much time to browse and book each individual element of my holiday. Ideally, I'll find some kind of package deal that comes with local restaurant recommendations…"

Meesho

meesho

"Good quality products at affordable prices make my life easier."



NAME:
Priya Sharma

PERSONAL BACKGROUND

AGE: 28

LOCATION: Indore, Madhya Pradesh

FAMILY: Married, 1 child (4 years)

EDUCATION: Bachelor's degree (B.Com)

LANGUAGE: Primarily Hindi

USER ENVIRONMENT

LOCATION: Tier 2 city (Indore)

LIVING SITUATION: Lives with husband, child and in-laws

INTERNET & DEVICE: Android smartphone, uses Meesho app daily, mostly on mobile data

COMFORT WITH TECH: Comfortable with apps like WhatsApp, UPI and Meesho

GOALS

- Find trendy and good quality products at affordable prices
- Shop for family needs (clothing, home essentials, kitchen items, kids' products)
- Save money through deals and offers
- Start a small reselling business to earn extra income
- Discover new and unique products not available locally

PROFESSIONAL BACKGROUND

OCCUPATION: Homemaker & part-time reseller on Meesho

INCOME: Household income ~ ₹35,000 per month

SIDE INCOME: Earns extra ₹5,000–8,000 per month through reselling on Meesho

WORK STYLE: Manages home and business through mobile

PSYCHOGRAPHICS

- Value-conscious and looks for the best deals
- Enjoys exploring new and trendy products
- Influenced by social media and WhatsApp groups
- Trusts reviews and real customer photos
- Feels good when she can provide good quality products to her family and customers
- Aspires to be financially independent

SCENARIO

"I usually browse Meesho in the evenings after my household work is done. I love checking new arrivals, especially sarees, kurtis and home decor items. Sometimes I buy for my family, and sometimes I share products with my WhatsApp customers. Meesho helps me get good quality products at low prices, and it also gives me a chance to earn from home."

JTBD

Jobs to Be Done: The Root Beneath the Persona

Zoom out from who the customer is to the progress they're actually trying to make.

Outcome, Not Tool

People "hire" a product for the functional, social, and emotional progress it delivers not the tool itself.

Circumstance Over Profile

A situation causes the purchase. Demographics rarely do — root-cause the trigger, not the persona label.

Job = Situation + Motivation + Outcome

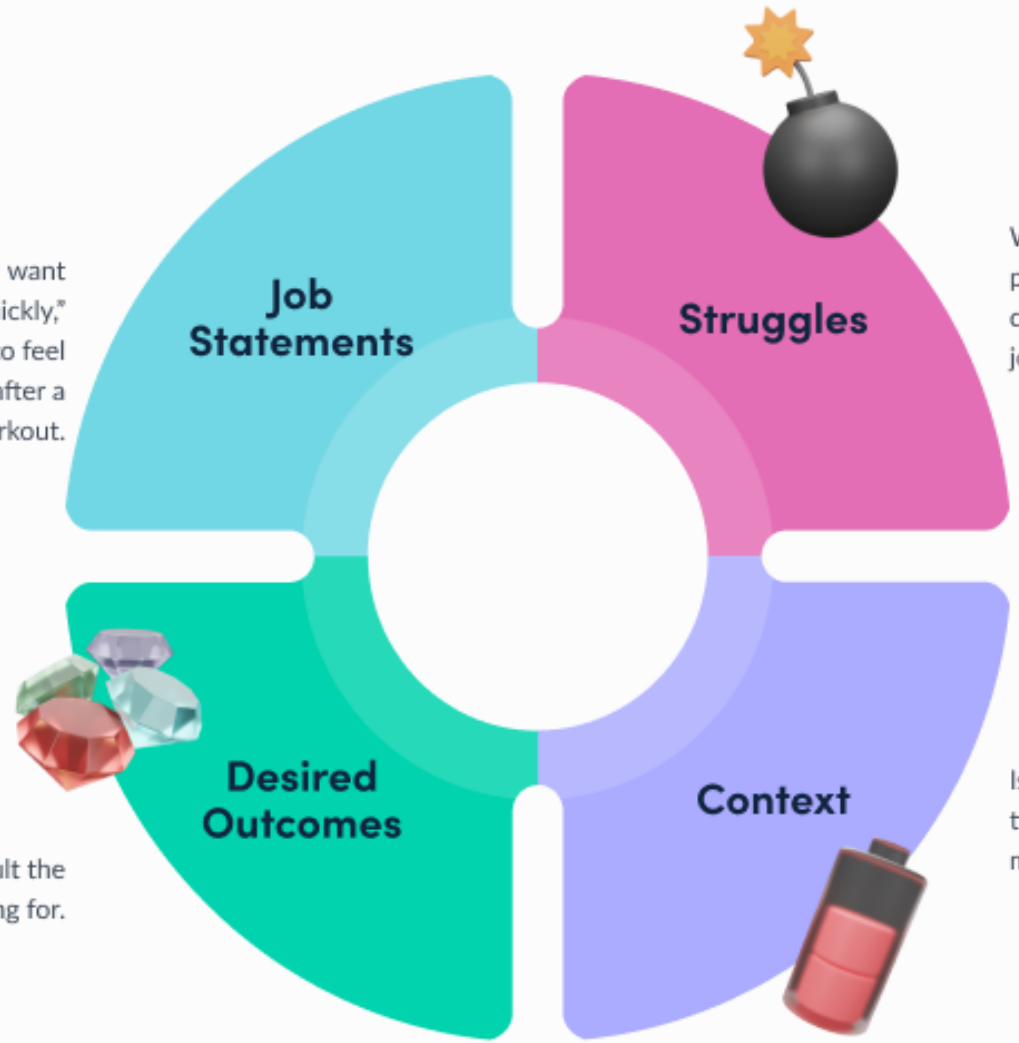
The real job sits at the intersection of what's happening, why it matters, and what "done" looks like.

Three Dimensions of Progress

Functional (the task), Emotional-Personal (how it feels), Emotional-Social (how it looks to others).

"When I ___ (situation), I want ___ (motivation), so I can ___ (outcome)."

JTBD Key Components

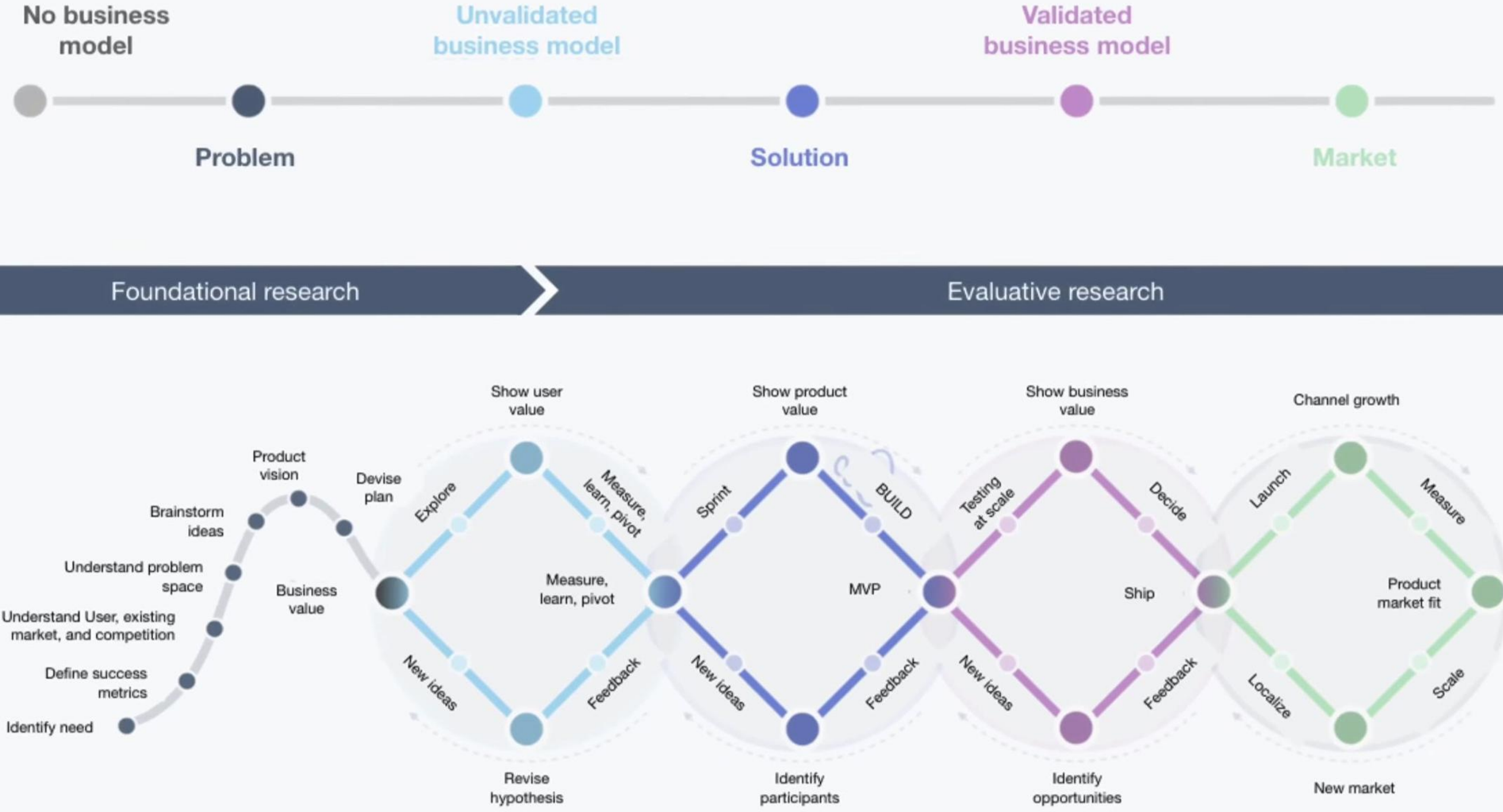


Can be functional "I want to clean my house quickly," or emotional "I want to feel accomplished after a workout.

What obstacles or pain points are preventing the customer from doing the job effectively?

The ideal result the user is looking for.

Is the user working under time pressure? Are they multitasking?


No business model
Unvalidated business model
Validated business model
Problem
Solution
Market
Foundational research
Evaluative research
Identify need
Define success metrics
Understand User, existing market, and competition
Understand problem space
Brainstorm ideas
Product vision
Devise plan
Business value
Explore
Show user value
Measure, learn, pivot
New ideas
Revise hypothesis
Feedback
Measure, learn, pivot
Sprint
Show product value
BUILD
MVP
New ideas
Identify participants
Feedback
Testing at scale
Show business value
Decide
Ship
New ideas
Identify opportunities
Feedback
Launch
Channel growth
Measure
Product market fit
Localize
Scale
New market

NotebookLM

JTBD Breakdown



> The **fundamental job** is: "When I am overwhelmed by information across multiple sources **(Situation)**, I want a grounded, synthesized understanding I can trust **(Motivation)**, so I can learn, decide, and act with confidence (**Expected Outcome**)."

Functional Job

(Core task completion)

Making sense of complex information quickly.

Summarizing documents, connecting ideas across sources, answering questions with citations, and turning information into useful formats.

Emotional Job (Personal)

Reducing the anxiety of information overload.

Feeling confident that I understand the material and can trace answers back to my sources.
Knowing I am not missing something important.

Emotional Job (Social)

Appearing informed and credible.

Being able to explain complex topics clearly, support claims with sources, and contribute confidently in meetings, classrooms, or discussions.

FIRST PRINCIPLES INSIGHT

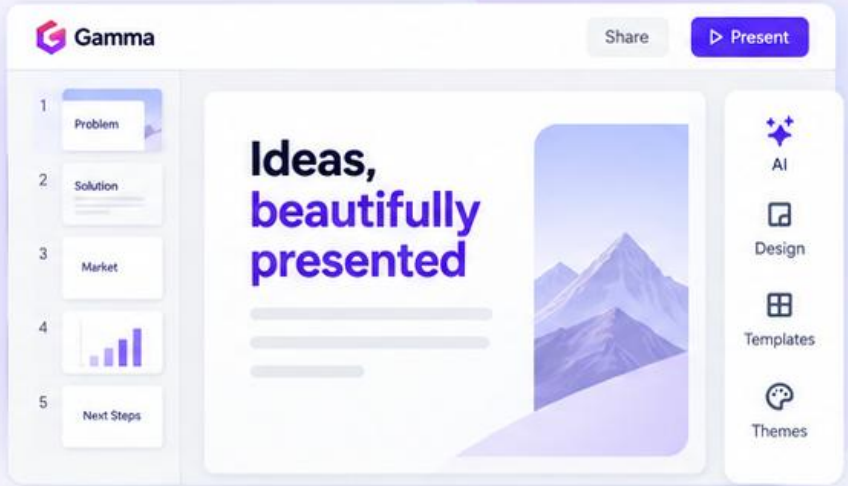
NotebookLM successfully unbundled the core job of "understanding information,"
solving the non-functional pains of information overload, uncertainty, and lack of trust that traditional reading and search leave unresolved.

Gamma

JTBD Breakdown

From ideas to impactful presentations, faster.

Turn your ideas into beautiful presentations



Create with AI. Present with impact.

> **The fundamental job is:** "When I have an idea or information to communicate **(Situation)**, I want a fast, easy, and beautiful way to create a compelling presentation **(Motivation)**, so I can share my ideas and make an impact **(Expected Outcome)**."

Functional Job

(Core task completion)

Creating high-quality presentations quickly.

Generating structured, visually appealing slides using AI, templates, and design tools with minimal effort, and iterating easily based on content and feedback.

Emotional Job (Personal)

Reducing the stress and friction of presentation creation.

Feeling confident even without design skills. Overcoming blank page anxiety. Enjoying the creative process and feeling proud of the output.

Emotional Job (Social)

Being seen as a clear and impactful communicator.

Sharing polished, professional, and visually compelling presentations that impress peers, clients, or stakeholders, and help ideas gain traction.

FIRST PRINCIPLES INSIGHT

Gamma successfully unbundled the core job of "presentation creation,"

solving the non-functional pains of design complexity, time consumption, and lack of confidence that traditional tools left unresolved.

#	Product	JTBD Statement
1	🚕 Uber	When I am in a new city needing transport, I want a reliable ride, so I can move around safely and confidently.
2	🎬 Netflix	When I want to relax, I want something entertaining that I will enjoy, so I can unwind without wasting time choosing.
3	🛍️ Meesho	When I have a limited budget, I want affordable choices, so I can get more value from my money.
4	💳 PhonePe	When I need to make a payment, I want to transfer money instantly, so I can complete the transaction and move on.
5	🏍️ Royal Enfield	When I want to ride, I want a motorcycle that feels powerful and distinctive, so I can enjoy the journey and express who I am.
6	🧹 Dyson	When I need to clean my home, I want powerful cleaning with less effort, so I can get the job done quickly.
7	💬 Slack	When my team needs to coordinate, I want communication organized around the work, so we can move projects forward efficiently.
8	🎨 Figma	When a team is designing together, I want everyone working in the same place, so we can collaborate and iterate faster.
9	💰 Razorpay	When my business needs to collect payments, I want simple digital payment infrastructure, so I can get paid without operational complexity.
10	🛠️ Bosch Power Tools	When I need to complete a physical job, I want a reliable and powerful tool, so I can finish the work efficiently.

ACTIVITY

5 MIN

Write Your Product's JTBD Statement

- Fill in: “When I ___ (situation), I want ___ (motivation), so I can ___ (outcome).”
- Check it against all three dimensions — functional, personal, social.
- Share it with your neighbour — does it sound like a job, or a feature request?

Hypothesis

Problem > Opportunity > Hypothesis

Product?
Customers?
Problems?

Now what? Create an opportunity

As a (user), I want to (perform a task), So that I can (achieve some goal)

Seeing It Filled In: A Ride-Hailing Example

As a rider trying to book a ride, **I want to launch the app and see my current location on the map** so that I can plan my trip.

PRIORITY: HIGH · set by the PM based on impact and effort

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- User is able to open the app
- User is able to see their precise location on the map

From here: design links a mockup, engineering adds tasks — the hypothesis is now something a team can build against.

Epic: Ride Booking Flow

User story 1

As a rider trying to book a ride, I want to enter my destination so that the app can calculate route, fare estimate, and available ride options.

Priority: High

Acceptance Criteria:

- User can type a destination or select from recent/saved places
- Autocomplete suggests addresses as the user types
- Selecting a destination shows estimated fare, distance, and ETA for each ride type
- User can edit the destination before confirming

User story 2

As a rider trying to book a ride, I want to choose a pickup point different from my current location so that I can be picked up from a nearby accessible spot.

Priority: Medium

Acceptance Criteria:

- User can drag the pin or search to set a custom pickup location
- App validates the pickup point is within a serviceable area
- App shows updated ETA for driver arrival based on new pickup point

User Story
As a rider trying to book a ride, I want to select a ride type (e.g., economy, premium, shared) so that I can choose based on budget and comfort.
Priority: High

User story
As a rider trying to book a ride, I want to confirm my ride request and see a searching/matching screen so that I know the app is actively finding a driver.
Priority: High

User story
As a rider waiting for pickup, I want to see my driver's live location and ETA on the map so that I know when they'll arrive.
Priority: High

User story
As a rider waiting for pickup, I want to view driver and vehicle details so that I can identify the correct car.
Priority: Medium

User story
As a rider trying to book a ride, I want to cancel a ride request before or shortly after a driver is assigned so that I'm not stuck if my plans change.

A Hypothesis Isn’t Done Until It’s Tested

MVP / Feature Launch

Ship the smallest real version and watch what actually happens.

A/B Testing

Run the hypothesis against the status quo with real traffic.

Interviews & Usability Tests

Watch people try to use it; listen for where they stumble.

Surveys

Check breadth — how many people share this reaction at scale.

Pick the method that matches your confidence and your cost of being wrong — not the one that’s easiest to run.